

DAILY NEED TO KNOW

Saturday, 1 August 2026 · Pre-market brief for Anne Wong

Covering the Friday 31 July 2026 US session — the last trading day of July — plus the weekend. All times GMT+8 (HKT).
Edition: **FULL** — Hedgeye logged-in edition (live Risk Ranges, TREND signals, Macro Show positioning). **WEEKEND EDITION** — cash and futures markets are shut; Asia reopens Monday 3 August.

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Market snapshot (Fri 31 Jul close)

ASSET	LAST	CHANGE	NOTE
S&P 500	7,489.72	▲ +52.09 / +0.70%	Closed 48pts under the 7,538 ceiling. Traded 7,399.83–7,512.04 — a 112-point round trip
Nasdaq Composite	25,373.85	▲ +251.68 / +1.00%	Second up day. Still –6.7% from the 27,190 June record
Dow Jones	52,485.03	▲ +276.97 / +0.53%	FOURTH straight winning month (+0.32% in July). The quiet winner again
Russell 2000	2,931.34	▼ –14.76 / –0.50%	The only major index down. Small caps did not join the bounce
US 2Y yield	4.262%	▲ +3.3 bp	CNBC 17:05 EDT. Ranged 4.227–4.308% intraday
US 10Y yield	4.745%	▲ +8.2 bp	HIGHEST SINCE JANUARY 2025 — and THROUGH Hedgeye's 4.71% ceiling
US 30Y yield	5.28%	▲ +7 bp	A FRESH 19-YEAR HIGH. Today's print is the 52-week high. It keeps going
Gold (Aug)	\$4,098.60	▼ –62.00 / –1.49%	Back INSIDE the \$3,991–\$4,139 band after two days through the top
Silver (Sep)	\$57.78	▼ –1.24 / –2.10%	Off the \$60 ceiling it was pressing. Still a bearish TREND
WTI crude (Sep)	\$86.80	▲ +3.21 / +3.84%	REVERSED a –1.6% Asian session on Kuwait/Bahrain strikes and Hormuz tanker turn-backs
Brent crude	\$90.12	▲ +1.09 / +1.22%	Back above \$90. Best month for crude since the war began, >20%
Bitcoin	~\$62,932	▼ –2.77% (24h)	ETH \$1,862 (–2.86%). BROKE the ~\$64,000 TRADE line; ETH signal now bearish
US Dollar (DXY)	99.80	▼ –0.06%	Held the 99.76 floor by 0.04. Keith McCullough went LONG the dollar
USD/JPY	157.40	▼ –1.38% (yen up)	Second intervention in 48 hours. BoJ held at 1.00%, 8–1, and sounded hawkish
VIX	15.99	▼ –1.10 / –6.44%	Spiked to 18.70 intraday, then collapsed. Signal DOWNGRADED to BEARISH
Copper (Sep)	\$6.51	▲ +0.03 / +0.51%	Inside a raised \$6.19–\$6.59 band. Still the cleanest bullish TREND on the board

Colour key: ▲ up ▼ down ◆ neutral/mixed ► little changed. Green/red denote whether the move is risk-positive, not direction: a rise in yields or VIX is coloured red/green accordingly. US cash closes are official 16:00 EDT Friday prints; commodity levels are 16:59 EDT electronic quotes with the session change as reported, and reconcile exactly to the 31 Jul edition's derived settles. Yield levels are Yahoo CBOE 15:00 EDT prints except the 2Y, which is CNBC at 17:05 EDT (see Data-confidence). Crypto changes are rolling 24-hour, not session.

TL;DR: Asia melted up and America refused to confirm it. Korea's Kospi rose **+17.91%** — its best day on record — to 6,595.45, with SK Hynix +25% and Samsung +20% triggering a trading halt; Taiwan +7.98%, Nikkei +4.03%, Advantest +18%, Disco +13%, Lasertec +12%, SoftBank +9%. Then New York sold every one of those names. Micron opened near \$931 and closed **\$823.03, -5.90%**; AMD traded \$515.62 and closed \$476.15; the Korea ETF (EWY) touched \$166.04 and closed -2.55%; SMH printed \$561.44 and closed +0.30%. The index still rose — but on Amazon **+15.32%** (AWS +37%), Alphabet +6.73% (Google Cloud +82%), Meta +3.28% and Microsoft +3.02%. Cloud, not chips. Apple fell **-7.35%** on a Services miss and a memory-cost guide, in Tim Cook's final earnings call. Underneath, the bond market voted the other way: the 10-year added 8.2bp to **4.745%**, the highest since January 2025, and the 30-year set another 19-year high at 5.28%. Oil reversed 5% intraday to \$86.80 after Iran said it struck US assets at Kuwait's Ahmad al-Jaber and Bahrain's Sheikh Isa air bases and the IRGC turned two tankers back from Hormuz. July closes with the S&P -0.13%, the Nasdaq Composite -3.20%, the Nasdaq-100 -6.95% (worst since March 2025), semis -16.9% (worst since 2008) — and the Dow up for a fourth straight month.

Friday's actionable levels — what broke, what held

- ▼ **US 10Y yield: 4.745% vs 4.59–4.71% (bullish) — the one that broke.** Hedgeye LOWERED the ceiling to 4.71% on Friday morning and the yield closed 3.5bp above it, at the highest level since January 2025. This is the second consecutive session in which the single most important price on the page went against a freshly-tightened range. Every equity move described below happened inside a discount rate that got worse, not better.
- ◆ **Tech (XLK): 175.35 vs 165–181 (bearish) — the test failed, precisely.** McCullough published the trigger in Friday's Early Look before the open: "*Immediate-term TRADE Signal Level = \$180; intermediate-term TREND = \$176,*" with the plan to stop out of the short if XLK recaptured \$180. It traded as high as \$178.62 and closed at \$175.35 — below TREND, below TRADE, and 4.65 short of the level that would have changed the position. The bounce was given a specific bar to clear and did not clear it.
- ▲ **US Dollar (DXY): 99.80 vs 99.76–102.01 (bullish) — held the floor by four hundredths.** Hedgeye cut the floor 76bp to 99.76 and widened the band to 2.25 points; the dollar traded 99.69 intraday, closed 99.80, and Keith initiated a **new long, expressed against the euro** rather than the yen "because the Bank of Japan sounded relatively hawkish overnight." A currency bought at the low end of its own range, one day after intervention took it there, is a positioning trade, not a macro call.
- ▼ **VIX: 15.99 vs 15.77–20.56, signal DOWNGRADED Bullish → BEARISH.** Two days ago the signal was upgraded to bullish with spot near the floor; on Friday it was downgraded to bearish with spot **0.22 off the floor**. The intraday high was 18.70. A bearish vol signal at the bottom of a lowered band, into the first week after month-end, is the configuration Keith explicitly flagged for vol-control and systematic selling.
- ◆ **S&P 500: 7,489.72 vs 7,316–7,538 (bullish) — 48 points under the ceiling.** The range was RAISED at both ends on Friday morning (from 7,276–7,462) and price finished in the top quarter of it. That is the constructive read. The uncomfortable one is that it took a 15% move in a 3.4%-weighted constituent to get there.
- ▲ **HY credit (HYG): 79.48 vs 78.97–79.76, UPGRADED Bearish → NEUTRAL.** Fourth signal change in five sessions (Neutral → Bearish → Neutral → Bearish → Neutral). Credit finally stopped dissenting — but it closed unchanged, +0.01%, on a day equities rose 0.70%. Neutral is not participation.
- ▲ **WTI: \$86.80 vs \$79.27–\$92.90 (bullish) — mid-range, and moving again.** Down 1.6% in Asian hours, up 3.84% on the close. Hedgeye is long the refiners (CRAK) and not the barrel, because oil is bullish TREND but bearish TRADE. CRAK fell 1.04% on a +3.84% crude day, which is the first crack in that expression this week.
- ▼ **Gold: \$4,098.60 vs \$3,991–\$4,139 (bearish) — back inside, after two days out.** The overshoot resolved downward, not by the range catching up. Keith describes gold as "early stages of a potential position build" needing a sequence of higher lows and then a bullish TRADE break; Friday's -1.49% interrupted that sequence.

2 The big picture — what it means

1. **The bounce happened in Asia and died in America.** Korea had the largest single-day gain in the history of its index — +17.91%, 1,001.89 points — because SK Hynix rose 25% and Samsung 20% on Thursday's New York re-rating of memory. Taiwan added 7.98%, Japan 4.03%, the Kosdaq 11.63%. Every one of those markets closed before the US opened. When New York got its turn, it sold: Micron -5.90% having been up as much as 6% at the high, AMD -1.90% off a \$515.62 print, Intel -1.02% off \$97.90, and EWY — the cleanest US-listed proxy for what Korea just did — closed **-2.55% after trading +5.7%**. Twelve hours of euphoria, fully retraced by the people who had actually been selling.
2. **The index went up anyway, on a completely different trade.** Amazon +15.32% on AWS +37%; Alphabet +6.73% on Google Cloud +82%; Microsoft +3.02% extending a month that is now its best since October 2007; Meta +3.28%. Consumer Cyclical closed +4.94% and Communication Services +3.99% — while Technology, the 31.6% weight, finished **-0.15%**. That is not the same rally as Thursday. Thursday was a short-covering squeeze in the most damaged part of the market. Friday was mega-cap cloud earnings paying out while the damaged part gave it all back. The leadership rotated inside 24 hours, which is a thing crashes do and bull markets do not.
3. **The bond market spent the day disagreeing, loudly.** The 10-year added 8.2bp to 4.745%, the highest since January 2025 and above the ceiling Hedgeye had just lowered to 4.71%. The 5-year added 8.5bp, the 30-year 7bp to another 19-year high at 5.28%. The 2-year added only 3.3bp — so the curve bear-steepened again, for the fourth session running. CNBC's framing was blunt: "*Treasury yields follow oil prices higher as Fed officials say rate hikes are needed.*" Equities closed at the top of their range into a discount rate at a 19-year high. One of those two prices is wrong and the bond market has been right for three weeks.
4. **Oil turned the day, and the war widened again.** WTI was \$82.24 in Asian hours, -1.62%, on Commonwealth Bank estimates that Hormuz traffic had recovered to 30–35% of pre-war levels. It closed \$86.80, +3.84%, after Iran's army said it had struck aircraft

shelters, satellite communications and equipment storage at Kuwait's Ahmad al-Jaber Air Base, claimed Thursday strikes on Bahrain's Sheikh Isa base, and Fars reported the IRGC had stopped two tankers in the Strait and turned four more around. A 5% intraday reversal in crude on the last day of a month in which crude rose more than 20% is what a risk premium with no floor under it looks like.

5. And the month itself is the story. S&P 500 -0.13%, Nasdaq Composite -3.20%, Nasdaq-100 -6.95% (worst month since March 2025), the VanEck Semiconductor ETF -16.9% (worst since 2008), Goldman's High Beta Momentum basket on track for the worst month in the series' history, a \$45bn hedge fund liquidated, a 19-year high in the long bond, a 40-year low in the yen followed by two interventions — and the Dow Jones Industrial Average up 0.32%, for a fourth consecutive winning month. Both of those facts describe July. Only one of them describes the index most people own.

3 Rates, currencies & commodities

- **Rates, and the bear steepener that will not stop.** 30Y 5.28% (+7bp), 10Y 4.745% (+8.2bp), 5Y 4.46% (+8.5bp), 2Y 4.262% (+3.3bp), 13-week bill 3.682% (+0.7bp). The belly led — which is the market pricing neither an imminent hike nor any relief, just more term premium. Every one of the 5Y, 10Y and 30Y is now at or within a basis point of its 52-week high; the 10Y's 52-week range top (4.75%) was effectively set on Friday's close. Keith's read on the Macro Show was that the 10-year Risk Range "was not offering a probable break below TRADE or TREND," which he called **a major problem for anything long-duration**.
- **Credit finally stopped voting no — without voting yes.** HYG 79.48, +0.01%, UPGRADED Bearish → Neutral (78.97–79.76). LQD 106.25, -0.15%, still bearish and now sitting on the very bottom of its 52-week range at 106.00. So high yield stopped falling and investment grade kept falling, on a day the S&P rose 0.70% and the long bond made a 19-year high. The HY signal has now flipped four times in five sessions, which is itself information: the process cannot find a stable read on credit, and unstable credit signals have preceded every leg of this drawdown.
- **The yen, twice in 48 hours.** USD/JPY 157.40, -1.38%, after a second suspected MoF intervention — week-to-date the dollar is down 3.3% against the yen, the biggest weekly slide since July 2024, having printed a 40-year low of 163.99 on Thursday morning. UBS's Paul Donovan: "Japan's Ministry of Finance seemingly intervened... This may have been more about the pace of weakness than any specific level." The BoJ then held at 1.00% on an 8–1 vote (Takata dissenting for 1.25%) and warned core inflation will run "clearly above" 2% from the second half of FY2026, citing wage pass-through, crude and the weak yen. Bloomberg read Ueda as mildly hawkish and September as live. DXY 99.80; EUR/USD 1.1527, GBP/USD 1.3487, AUD/USD 0.7025 — all essentially unchanged, so this was a yen event, not a dollar event.
- **Oil reversed, and the geography of the war changed again.** WTI \$86.80 (+3.84%), Brent \$90.12 (+1.22%), having been \$82.24 and \$88.16 respectively during Asian hours. The turn came on the Fars tanker report and the Kuwait strike. For the month, crude posted its best gain since the war began — more than 20% — and Hedgeye's WTI band (\$79.27–\$92.90, bullish) contained all of it. Energy was the third-best sector at +0.95% and XLE +1.00%; Chevron +2.35% on a quarter in which net income rose roughly 400% to \$12bn. Note the divergence: CRAK, the refiner ETF Keith is long, fell 1.04%.
- **Metals gave the Quad 3 trade back.** Gold -1.49% to \$4,098.60, back inside a band it had cleared twice; silver -2.10% to \$57.78, off the \$60 top; palladium -2.31%; platinum -0.28%. Copper was the exception at +0.51% to \$6.51, inside a ceiling raised again to \$6.59 and still the only bullish-TREND metal on the sheet. Natural gas +1.23% to \$2.792, still bearish. Precious metals selling off while the dollar sits on its floor and real yields make new highs is the cleanest possible statement that Friday's marginal buyer was reaching for duration-insensitive cash flows, not for inflation protection.

4 Hedgeye Risk Ranges & regime

Regime: August is modelled **Quad 3** — growth slowing, inflation accelerating — after a July that ended as a Quad 4 month on the calendar and a momentum crash in practice. Friday's Early Look, "**Crash, Bounce, Then?**" (Keith McCullough, 07:38 EDT), was published off Thursday's close and therefore framed exactly the session just traded. Its argument was mechanical, not directional: "*markets bounce big because they crashed*," and Day 1 of a bounce proves nothing. The execution plan was stated in advance and in public — reduce shorts near oversold lows, wait for a TRADE recapture, stop out only on a TREND recapture. He then named the specific test: "*since I reduced my XLK Short to minimum position size on Wednesday... I'll wait and watch to see if it recaptures \$180. If it does, I stop out.*" XLK closed 175.35. It did not.

INSTRUMENT	IMMEDIATE-TERM RISK RANGE	TREND	CHANGE VS THURSDAY
S&P 500 (SPX)	7,316 – 7,538	Bullish	RAISED from 7,276–7,462; close 48pts under the ceiling
Nasdaq Composite (COMPQ)	24,314 – 25,569	Bearish	Floor raised; close 195pts under an unchanged ceiling
Russell 2000 (RUT)	2,904 – 2,990	Bullish	RAISED from 2,887–2,978; price fell back toward the floor
US 10Y yield	4.59 – 4.71%	Bullish	Ceiling LOWERED from 4.75% — and the yield closed THROUGH it at 4.745%
US Dollar (DXY)	99.76 – 102.01	Bullish	Floor CUT 100.52 → 99.76, band widened to 2.25pts; close held by 0.04. New long initiated

INSTRUMENT	IMMEDIATE-TERM RISK RANGE	TREND	CHANGE VS THURSDAY
WTI crude	\$79.27 – \$92.90	Bullish	Essentially unchanged; spot mid-range after a 5% intraday reversal
Nat gas	\$2.61 – \$2.93	Bearish	Floor raised 2.55 → 2.61; spot \$2.792
Gold	\$3,991 – \$4,139	Bearish	Nudged up again; spot fell back INSIDE after two closes through the top
Silver	\$55 – \$60	Bearish	Unchanged for a third session; spot backed off the \$60 ceiling
Copper	\$6.19 – \$6.59	Bullish	Ceiling RAISED again, 6.55 → 6.59; floor raised 6.14 → 6.19
VIX	15.77 – 20.56	Bearish	DOWNGRADED from Bullish; whole band lowered; close 0.22 off the FLOOR
HY credit (HYG)	78.97 – 79.76	Neutral	UPGRADED from Bearish — fourth flip in five sessions
IG credit (LQD)	105.7 – 107.3	Bearish	Floor raised 105.5 → 105.7; spot 106.25, at its 52-week low
Tech (XLK)	\$165 – \$181	Bearish	RAISED from 163–177. TRADE \$180 / TREND \$176 — close 175.35 failed BOTH
Health Care (XLV)	\$159 – \$168	Bullish	Floor trimmed 160 → 159; Keith bought the down day
Real Estate (XLRE)	\$44.99 – \$46.40	Bullish	Ceiling cut 46.50 → 46.40; close 45.07, near the floor. Also bought

Ranges are from Friday's Early Look, published 07:38 EDT Friday off Thursday's close — i.e. they framed the session just traded. ONE broke: the US 10Y yield, through its ceiling. Everything else held, including the dollar floor by 0.04 and the VIX floor by 0.22. Signal changes vs Thursday: VIX Bullish → BEARISH (16.65–21.50 → 15.77–20.56); HYG Bearish → NEUTRAL (78.90–79.70 → 78.97–79.76). Friday's Early Look did not publish a Utilities (XLU) range, and did not publish USD/JPY, Brent, Nikkei, Kospi, Shanghai or DAX. There is no Early Look on Saturday; the next one publishes ~19:25 GMT+8 Monday.

Also on the desk — what Keith actually did

- ▲ **NEW LONG: the US dollar, against the euro.** Initiated on an immediate-term oversold signal near the low end of the Risk Range. His explanation of the mechanism is worth keeping: the dollar first rose because leveraged funds were forced to raise cash as equities fell; when that forced deleveraging stopped, the dollar reversed hard enough to trigger the buy. He explicitly declined to express it against the yen "because the Bank of Japan sounded relatively hawkish overnight." Bullish TREND, not yet bullish TRADE.
- ▼ **NEW SHORTS: lithium, and Hedge Fund VIP (GVIP).** Lithium was sourced through the Alpha Code screen "rather than through a fundamental narrative or Wall Street analyst recommendation." GVIP — the basket of the most widely-held hedge fund longs — was added to the short side in an ETF Pro update at 10:35 EDT; Wheat (WEAT) was removed from the long side. GVIP closed -0.64% on a +0.70% S&P day.
- ▲ **BOUGHT on weakness: Real Estate (XLRE) and Health Care (XLV).** Both fell on Friday — XLRE -0.51%, XLV -0.59% — and both made money through the monthly drawdown, which is precisely why he added. Also long the equal-weight S&P (RSP), Brazil (EWZ, added materially toward the top of his sizing range), New Zealand (ENZL) and the Philippines (EPHE) — markets "at approximately three-month highs while heavily owned technology and semiconductor exposures were declining."
- ▼ **BEARISH: Bitcoin versus the dollar.** His preferred negative-correlation trade to the new dollar long. BTC broke its immediate-term TRADE level near \$64,000 and is now below both TRADE and TREND — "quite bearish." It closed the week around \$62,930. Friday's Crypto Quant headline: "*฿TC (-1.4%), And Then There Were None (Again)... ETH=BEARISH, COIN 2Q Miss, 'The Quietest Tape'.*" Coinbase closed -10.59% on a third consecutive quarterly loss.
- ◆ **EXITED: all European positions, and Utilities.** He covered Europe "before European markets moved higher" and framed the exits as the signal removing exposure ahead of a reversal. XLU closed -0.69%.
- **The rest of the desk.** MOMO Tracker (08:34 EDT): "Mag7 (+2%), MSFT=BULLISH, AMZN=NEUTRAL, Crash → Oversold → Bounce → Then?" Chart of the Day: "*The Bigger The Crash, The More Deceptive The Bounce.*" Portfolio Solutions daily ETF re-rank top movers: XLV (+12), RSP (+9), AAAU (+6) — health care, equal weight and gold, i.e. everything that is not the momentum trade. Signal Strength Stocks: 66 names, 4 added, 4 removed. And still the most-read piece on the platform: "*Goldman's High Beta Momentum Basket on Track For Worst Monthly Performance in History.*" That record is now set.

5 Mag7 scoreboard (Fri 31 Jul)

NAME	LAST	DAY	CAP	READ
Amazon (AMZN)	\$271.58	▲ +15.32%	\$2.92T	The top S&P 500 gainer

NAME	LAST	DAY	CAP	READ
				and the biggest Mag7 move of the week. AWS +37% to \$42.2bn — fastest in 15 quarters. Yahoo called it a "home run" quarter. Capex to ~\$220bn.
Alphabet (GOOGL)	\$356.13	▲ +6.73%	\$4.36T	Google Cloud revenue +82%. The AI-monetisation bid found it two days after it was being sold as a safe harbour. Slipped 0.67% after hours.
Meta (META)	\$556.71	▲ +3.28%	\$1.42T	A bounce, not a repair. Still roughly 30% below the 52-week high of \$796.25 after Wednesday's -7.95%.
Microsoft (MSFT)	\$464.72	▲ +3.02%	\$3.45T	Extended Thursday's +15.5%. Now up more than 20% in July — its best month since October 2007. Was +1.5% MTD as of Wednesday.
Nvidia (NVDA)	\$200.75	▲ +2.93%	\$4.86T	Back over \$200 and the world's largest company again. Participated without leading, for a third straight session.
Tesla (TSLA)	\$311.21	▲ +0.76%	\$1.23T	Held \$300 for a third day. Still the Mag7 laggard year-to-date with no catalyst of its own.
Apple (AAPL)	\$308.91	▼ -7.35%	\$4.54T	WORST Mag7 day. Services and China revenue both short; September quarter guided light on "supply constraints" and higher memory costs. Tim Cook's final earnings call as CEO.

Prices are Friday 31 July official cash closes (16:00 EDT) from a single consistent Yahoo Finance snapshot; market caps as reported by the same source. Six of seven rose. Every close reconciles to the tick against the 31 July edition's Thursday prints. The four hyperscalers — Amazon, Microsoft, Alphabet and Meta — have now collectively guided to \$720–745bn of 2026 capital expenditure, and Bloomberg puts Big Tech's total outstanding AI spending commitments at roughly \$2 trillion.

6 Positioning & options

- **The intraday reversal is the whole day.** Micron traded \$930.88 and closed \$823.03 — a 11.6% round trip inside one session, finishing -5.90%. AMD: high \$515.62, close \$476.15. Intel: high \$97.90, close \$90.20. SMH: high \$561.44, close \$540.53. EWY: high \$166.04, close \$157.10, -2.55%. Every one of those opened on Korea's record day and was distributed into. The S&P itself printed 7,399.83 at the low — below Thursday's close — before finishing at 7,489.72. Two-way, and heavy.
- **Equal weight had a historically bad relative day.** RSP closed -0.17% against the S&P 500 cap-weighted +0.70% — 87 basis points of underperformance in a single session. Keith flagged it directly on the Macro Show as comparable only with episodes around 2000 and the pandemic, and said it was "consequential and worth monitoring rather than dismissing as normal volatility." He remains long RSP. On Wednesday the same trade was working; the concentration is re-asserting itself.
- **The bounce math is unforgiving.** Hedgeye's framing: High Beta Momentum rebounded roughly 14% across Thursday and Friday and remains approximately 60% below its peak — which requires about a 150% gain to recover. Korea rose 17.91% in a day and is still around 28–30% below its 52-week high of 9,385.59. A very large percentage bounce off a very low base is arithmetic, not a signal, and Friday's Chart of the Day made exactly that point: *"The Bigger The Crash, The More Deceptive The Bounce."*
- **Month-end is the risk, not the relief.** Keith explicitly warned that volatility-control and systematic funds could begin selling *after* month-end, that negative gamma amplifies declines and produces sharp countertrend rebounds, and that "the first week after month-end" is therefore the one that matters. That week starts Monday. VIX at 15.99 with a bearish signal and a lowered band is the cheapest that insurance has been in three weeks.

- **Retail never got bullish, which is not the contrarian comfort it looks like.** AAll bearishness was 42.1% in the week to Wednesday — a 25th consecutive week above the 31.0% historical average, the longest such run since before the Iran war began in February. Bulls at 31.0% remain below the 37.5% average for a second week. Sentiment has been pessimistic through both the crash and the bounce; it is not a timing tool here.
- **And the year's largest single blow-up is now confirmed and finished.** Leopold Aschenbrenner's Situational Awareness — \$45bn at the start of July — was margin-called into liquidating its entire public book. JPMorgan told clients the deleveraging in tech, semis and memory "has advanced faster than we had previously anticipated" with "more limited room for any further deleveraging." That is why the crash stopped. It is not why it would restart.

7 Sector rotation — leaders & laggards (Fri)

- ▲ **Leaders:** Consumer Cyclical **+4.94%** (Amazon alone), Communication Services **+3.99%** (Alphabet), Energy +0.95%, Industrials +0.39%, Financial Services +0.37%. Single names: Replimune +133% (FDA advisory committee voted 10–3 for RP1 in advanced melanoma; decision due 2 August), IES Holdings +30.3%, AXT +28.7%, Integer Holdings +20.2%, Ambarella +16.1%, Amazon +15.3%, Alphabet +6.7%, Chevron +2.4%. The refiners kept making all-time highs — PBF Energy, Delek US, Par Pacific and HF Sinclair all closed at records on Thursday, with PBF up 170% year-to-date on crack spreads the Iran war created.
- ▼ **Laggards:** Healthcare **−0.55%** (worst), Utilities −0.37%, Consumer Defensive −0.27%, Technology **−0.15%**. Single names: Roblox −26.9%, Universal Music −23% and halted in Amsterdam (adjusted EBITDA −0.3% y/y; subscription revenue +16.6% against a 19% forecast) with Vivendi −17.8%, Veracyte −22.5%, Reddit −21.0% — its worst day on record, on no new AI licensing deals and a US daily-user miss — Alignment Healthcare −20.2%, MasTec −18.9%, GoDaddy −10.9%, Coinbase −10.6%, Novo Nordisk −8.8% (ziltivekimab failed to reduce major adverse cardiovascular events), Apple −7.4%, Micron −5.9%, SpaceX −3.4% to a record low.
- ◆ **Rotation read.** Two sectors did 100% of the work and they were the two that own Amazon and Alphabet. Strip those out and Friday was a down day: Technology, Healthcare, Consumer Defensive and Utilities all fell, the Russell 2000 fell, equal weight fell, and the intraday low was below Thursday's close. Wednesday the leadership broke; Thursday the most damaged names squeezed; Friday the squeeze was sold and two earnings winners carried the tape. Three sessions, three different explanations for the index level. That is the definition of an unstable market, and it is why one day of anything — up or down — is currently worth very little.

8 Forward — the weekend and the week ahead

- **Markets are shut.** CME Globex reopens Sunday 18:00 EDT — 06:00 GMT+8 Monday. Friday's 16:59 EDT settles: S&P futures 7,503.50 (+0.41%), Nasdaq-100 28,287.00 (+0.17%), Dow 52,524 (+0.27%), Russell 2,928.40 (**−0.88%**). Treasury futures closed on the lows — the long bond contract −0.97%. The only thing that traded over the weekend is crypto: Bitcoin ~\$62,930 (−2.77% on 24 hours), Ethereum ~\$1,862 (−2.86%), Solana \$72.88, XRP \$1.06. Bitcoin is below both its TRADE and TREND levels and 42.9% lower than a year ago.

DAY (GMT+8)	KEY EVENTS
Mon 3 Aug	★ Asia reopens and has to price the fact that New York did not confirm Friday's melt-up. Korea, Taiwan and Japan gapped on Thursday's New York close; the US then sold Micron 5.9%, AMD 1.9% and EWY 2.6% from the highs. Kospi at 6,595 after a record +17.91% day, Taiwan at 43,120 after +7.98%, Nikkei at 64,362 after +4.03% — all into a US tape that faded them. ★ US ISM Manufacturing (prior 53.3) and June construction spending, 22:00. China Caixin manufacturing PMI, after the official gauge unexpectedly contracted to 49.2. Earnings: Palantir, Pfizer, Caterpillar, McDonald's.
Tue 4 Aug	★ SpaceX (SPCX) reports for the first time since its June IPO — into a record-low share price, a −36% month, more than \$1.2trn of market value erased from the 16 June high of \$225.64, and a major share unlock with short interest reported to be soaring. This is the single most binary event of the week for sentiment in the new-issue complex.
Wed 5 Aug	ADP employment, US ISM Services, China Caixin services PMI. AMD reports — the name that traded \$515.62 and closed \$476.15 on Friday, into a completely different tape from the one it was priced for a week ago.
Fri 7 Aug	★ US July employment report , 20:30. Consensus looks for the unemployment rate to edge back up to 5.4%. This is the first hard labour print since three FOMC members dissented in favour of a hike on 29 July, and the first one that lands on a 30-year yield at 5.28%.
Watch	Whether the first week after month-end brings the vol-control and systematic selling Keith flagged. Whether the 10-year, having closed above a lowered 4.71% ceiling, keeps going — the 5Y, 10Y and 30Y are all at or on their 52-week highs. Hormuz: traffic

DAY (GMT+8)

KEY EVENTS

is back to only 30–35% of pre-war levels and Trump has offered no timeline for reopening; nine vessels have now been struck at or heading to the Caspian Pipeline Consortium terminal in July alone, a monthly record since 2022. And the structural one: Fed Chair Kevin Warsh has raised **reducing the number of FOMC meetings** from eight per year — a decision could come before the mid-September meeting.

9 Corporate news

- **Amazon: the quarter that carried the index.** Shares +15.32% to \$271.58, adding roughly \$390bn of market value, on AWS +37% year-over-year to \$42.2bn — the fastest growth in 15 quarters — with the AI business and Amazon's own silicon each running above a \$25bn annualised rate. The cost of it: 2026 capex raised to roughly \$220bn from \$200bn on higher memory prices, and trailing-twelve-month free cash flow now an outflow. The market has now twice in 48 hours chosen the cloud growth rate over the cash flow.
- **Apple: the other side of the same shortage.** Shares -7.35% to \$308.91, the worst Mag7 day and roughly \$360bn of market value, after Services revenue and China both came in short and the September quarter was guided light on "supply constraints." Tim Cook, in what Fortune noted was his final earnings call as CEO, warned directly on memory costs. Apple is the cleanest large-cap short expression of the memory squeeze and it has now said so on the record twice.
- **Alphabet: +6.73% on an 82% cloud number.** Google Cloud revenue grew 82%, and the market treated it as evidence that AI capital expenditure converts to revenue rather than merely to depreciation. Alphabet is now a \$4.36trn company and has closed higher on the two days its peers rotated hardest.
- **Chevron and Exxon, on a war quarter.** Chevron net income \$12bn, up roughly 400% from \$2.5bn a year ago; adjusted EPS \$6.06, fifty cents ahead. CEO Mike Wirth: *"We're kind of firing on all cylinders, which is good, because the world needs it."* Shares +2.35%. Exxon also beat on surging crude but closed -0.97%, having been down more than 2% intraday — the market is paying for the refining and downstream leverage, not the integrated majors.
- **The AI-revenue reality check nobody expected: Reddit.** Down 20.99% to \$140.67 — the worst day in the company's history — because it did not announce new AI data-licensing deals and its US daily active user metric disappointed. Reddit was the first pure-play "our data is worth something to model builders" story. The first time that revenue line failed to grow, the multiple went with it. Watch which other content and data businesses are being valued on the same assumption.
- **Deals, and one very large one.** Blackstone agreed to acquire HSBC's A\$36bn (\$25bn) Australian home and personal loan portfolio — Blackstone calls it the largest home loan portfolio transaction globally; HSBC's Hong Kong shares hit an intraday record. Alimentation Couche-Tard will buy Poland's Żabka at about \$8.6bn after Seven & i could not agree terms. BP announced it will sell its entire North Sea business, roughly 1,100 employees, two central North Sea hubs and three sites west of Shetland. Jersey Mike's recovered slightly after closing 6% below its \$23 IPO price on debut.
- **And the rest of the tape.** Novo Nordisk -8.78% after ziltivekimab failed to cut major adverse cardiovascular events in a late-stage trial. Universal Music -23% and halted, dragging Vivendi -17.8%. Coinbase -10.59% on a third consecutive quarterly loss. Moderna cut its 2026 R&D budget to \$2.9bn. Roblox -26.85%. On the other side, Replimune +133% after an FDA advisory committee backed RP1 by 10–3. The Trump administration added six chipmakers to the US government's equity portfolio, and Elon Musk launched X Money with an X-branded Visa card.

10 Macro data

- **Labour costs ran hot, and still lost to inflation.** The Q2 employment cost index rose 0.9% against a 0.8% consensus, and 3.4% year-over-year — just below the 3.5% CPI. So compensation is accelerating enough to worry a committee that already had three dissents for a hike, and not enough to stop real wages falling. That is the worst of both readings, and it is the one the front end traded: the 2-year rose only 3.3bp while the 5-year rose 8.5bp.
- **Consumer sentiment rebounded off a very low base.** The final University of Michigan reading for July was 55.2, up 11.5% on the month and ahead of the 54.0 consensus — but still 10.5% below a year ago. One-year inflation expectations fell 0.4pp to 4.2%, the lowest since March; the five-year measure was unchanged at 3.3%. Survey director Joanne Hsu: *"sentiment is 11% below a year ago, reflecting a generally somber view of the economy amid five years of elevated inflation and persistent high prices."* Note that this improvement happened despite higher pump prices, which is unusual and worth watching.
- **China went backwards.** The official manufacturing PMI fell to 49.2 in July from 50.3, against a 50.0 consensus — the first contraction since February — as the export front-running that powered the Q2 rebound unwound. This is the second-largest economy losing its manufacturing impulse in the same month that oil rose more than 20%, and it puts real pressure on Beijing to move on domestic demand. The Shanghai Composite closed +0.72% and the CSI 300 +0.85% anyway.
- **Japan held, and warned.** The BoJ kept its policy rate at 1.00% on an 8–1 vote, Hajime Takata dissenting for 1.25%. The Outlook Report said core inflation will accelerate "clearly above" 2% from the second half of FY2026 — citing wage pass-through, crude and the weak yen — before falling back as oil declines. Japan's July core CPI was 1.6%, below target for most of 2026. Bloomberg read Ueda as mildly hawkish; the market read September as live. All of that came hours after the government intervened in the currency for a second time.
- **And the institution itself is changing.** The New York Times reported Friday that Fed Chair Kevin Warsh raised the possibility of **reducing the number of FOMC policy meetings** from the current eight per year, during this week's gathering; a decision could come before the mid-September meeting. Read it alongside the 29 July decision to hold with three dissents for a hike and no forward

guidance. Fewer meetings and less guidance means more of the adjustment happens in the bond market between meetings — which is precisely what the 5.28% long bond has been doing.

11 Geopolitics

- ▼ **Iran hit two Gulf states, and named the targets.** Iran's army said on Friday that it had struck aircraft shelters, satellite communication systems and equipment storage used by the US military at Kuwait's Ahmad al-Jaber Air Base with drones, and claimed a Thursday attack on US facilities at Bahrain's Sheikh Isa Air Base targeting power generators, navigation systems and support buildings. This followed a US "heavy wave" on Wednesday against dozens of IRGC targets nationwide. The exchange is now openly reciprocal and the Gulf states are inside it.
- ▼ **The maritime war is no longer about the chokepoint.** Egypt confirmed a drone struck two ships at Damietta on the Mediterranean — the first attack on Egyptian soil since the war began in late February, and unclaimed. Verisk Maplecroft's Hamish Kinnear: the strike signals that **the Suez Canal is also a potential target**, and attacks on shipping this year now span "the Caspian Sea, Black Sea, Mediterranean Sea, Red Sea, Persian Gulf, and the Indian Ocean... a new era of maritime risk." Separately, nine vessels have been struck at or heading to the Caspian Pipeline Consortium terminal in July — a monthly record going back to 2022.
- ▼ **Hormuz went the wrong way, again, and that is what moved oil.** Commonwealth Bank estimated Friday morning that transit had recovered to 30–35% of pre-war levels and that 50–60% would be enough to reassert oversupply — which is why crude was down 1.6% in Asia. Then Fars, the IRGC-linked agency, said the Revolutionary Guards had stopped two tankers from passing and that four more had changed course. CNBC could not independently verify it. Crude closed +3.84%. Trump has offered no timeline for a reopening.
- **The read.** Compare with 24 hours earlier, when the same market shrugged off fresh US strikes and Brent fell 1.9%. On Friday a single unverified tanker report added 5% to WTI intraday. That is not a market with a settled risk premium — it is one that has stopped believing any particular level is defensible, and will therefore keep repricing violently in both directions on headlines of uncertain provenance. For anyone with energy exposure, the position size is now the decision; the direction is not tradeable on news.

12 Asia — Friday's session, and the Monday setup

INDEX	FRI 31 JUL CLOSE	READ
Kospi (Korea)	▲ 6,595.45 (+17.91%)	THE BEST DAY IN THE INDEX'S HISTORY — +1,001.89 points. SK Hynix +25%, its own record day, and Samsung +20%, triggering a trading halt. Still ~29% below its 52-week high.
Kosdaq (Korea)	▲ 719.76 (+11.63%)	The small-cap leg confirmed it. LG Innotek +11.2%, Seoul Semiconductor +7.8%.
Taiwan (TWII)	▲ 43,119.75 (+7.98%)	Fifth session reversed in one. Ranged 41,610–43,214; closed at the high.
Nikkei 225	▲ 64,362.02 (+4.03%)	Advantest +18%, Disco +13%, Lasertec +12%, Renesas +10%, Tokyo Electron +9%, SoftBank +9% — into a BoJ hold and a second intervention.
Shenzhen	▲ 13,578.93 (+2.21%)	Outperformed Shanghai on the tech read-through.
Shanghai	▲ 3,832.26 (+0.72%)	CSI 300 +0.85% to 4,588.20 — despite the official manufacturing PMI contracting to 49.2.
Sensex	▲ 78,094.64 (+0.21%)	Fourth straight gain. India stayed the region's low-beta leg through the whole episode.
Hang Seng	▲ 25,884.43 (+0.10%)	Fourth green day, and the least excited market in Asia. Ranged 25,623–25,917.
S&P/ASX 200	▲ 8,976.80 (+0.10%)	Barely participated; faded from 9,059.80 intraday as Brent slipped in Asian hours.
S&P/NZX 50	▼ 13,699.28 (–0.46%)	Closed on the low. Hedgeye is long New Zealand (ENZL) off three-month highs.
Straits Times	▼ 5,628.50 (–0.79%)	Second down day, now 1.5% off last week's 52-week high.

Read: Asia traded Friday on Thursday's New York close — a +2.78% Nasdaq, a +18.4% Micron and a Samsung supply warning — and priced it in full. It did not get to see what happened next. The US then distributed the entire move: Micron fell 5.90% from a \$930.88 high, AMD closed \$476.15 having traded \$515.62, SMH gave back \$21 from its high, and EWY — the US-listed Korea ETF and therefore the only place Friday's Korean tape could be marked in real time — closed DOWN 2.55% after trading up 5.7%. That –2.55% is Monday's gap risk for Seoul in a single number. Set against it: Korea and Taiwan are still 28–30% and well below their highs, the forced seller is finished, and the memory supply story Samsung told is unchanged. Both things are true. The Kospi's best day on record is a market-structure event — a 40% drawdown, a record short base and a trading halt — and market-structure events do not compound. Brief lands –08:00 GMT+8 Saturday; all Asian cash markets are closed until Monday.

13 AI watch

- **The capex number is now the whole debate, and it got bigger.** Across this week's reports the four hyperscalers — Amazon, Microsoft, Alphabet and Meta — have guided to a combined **\$720–745bn of 2026 capital expenditure**, and Bloomberg puts Big Tech's total outstanding AI spending commitments at roughly **\$2 trillion**. Two weeks ago the market was selling these names on fear that AI demand was rolling over. It is not the demand that is in question now. It is who funds the depreciation, and at what cost of capital — with the 10-year at 4.745% and the 30-year at 5.28%.
- **The revenue side keeps refusing to decelerate.** Azure past \$100bn of annual revenue on 43% constant-currency growth; AWS +37% and accelerating to its fastest in 15 quarters, with AI and custom silicon each above a \$25bn run rate; Google Cloud +82%. Three different clouds, three different starting points, all accelerating in the same quarter. Whatever else is true about this cycle, the enterprise spend showing up in reported revenue is real and it is compounding.
- **But the market has now separated the sellers of AI from the buyers of memory — twice, in two days.** Thursday: memory producers +18% to +22% on a Samsung shortage warning. Friday: Micron -5.90%, AMD -1.90%, SMH round-tripping \$21, while Amazon and Alphabet, which pay for that memory, rose 15% and 7%. Apple, which pays for it and cannot pass it on quickly, fell 7.35% naming exactly that cost. The shortage is simultaneously a three-year pricing regime and a margin problem, and the market is refusing to hold both positions on the same day.
- **Reddit is the first data point on the other AI trade.** -20.99%, the worst day in its history, for the absence of new AI data-licensing agreements. The "our corpus is a strategic asset" thesis has been supporting valuations across content, forums, publishing and market data. Friday priced what happens when those deals are one-time rather than recurring. It is a small company and a large signal.
- **And the cautionary tale is now closed out.** A \$45bn fund run by a 24-year-old former OpenAI researcher, holding the most intellectually fashionable position in the market — levered long AI hardware, short the enterprise software it was supposed to disrupt — has been liquidated in full after a margin call. It was right about the technology. The price path killed it anyway. Friday's Early Look put the same idea more usefully: *"Conviction and attachment are not the same thing, and confusing them is where most of the real risk tends to live."*

14 Beyond the markets

- **A government intervened twice in 48 hours and then did nothing.** Japan bought yen on Thursday, bought again on Friday, and the Bank of Japan then held at 1.00% — while telling the market inflation will run "clearly above" 2% from September. The yen is 3.3% stronger on the week and still weaker than at any point in four decades save this week. Reserves can buy a level for a day; only the rate differential holds one. Tokyo has now spent the former twice while declining to change the latter, and the September meeting is where that gets resolved.
- **The Fed is deliberately becoming harder to read.** No forward guidance, three dissents in the hawkish direction, and now a proposal from the Chair to meet less often. There is a coherent case for it — central banks that speak less force markets to price fundamentals rather than communication. There is also a cost, and Friday showed it: with nothing to trade off, the market traded oil, and yields followed crude to a 19-year high in the long bond. Less information does not reduce volatility. It relocates it.
- **A 17.91% day is not good news.** The Kospi's largest single-session gain in its history happened because two stocks hit trading halts inside an index that had fallen roughly 40% from its high. The list of markets that have posted their biggest-ever daily gains is not a list of markets that were healthy at the time. Keith's number is the one to hold: down 60%, you need 150% back. Percentage moves off a crashed base flatter the recovery and tell you almost nothing about it.
- **And July is now in the record books, twice over.** In the same 22 sessions: the worst month in the history of Goldman's High Beta Momentum basket; the worst month for semiconductors since 2008; the worst month for the Nasdaq-100 since March 2025; the largest single-day market-value gain by any company ever; the largest single-day gain in the history of the Korean stock market; a \$45bn fund liquidated; a 19-year high in the 30-year Treasury; a 40-year low in the yen and two interventions; a Gulf state entering a shooting war; the first attack on Egyptian soil of the conflict — and a Dow Jones Industrial Average that closed up 0.32%, its fourth consecutive winning month. If you owned the index and read nothing, July was uneventful. Almost nobody owned the index.

15 Appendix — stock cards

Names in focus plus top global names — last + day · market cap · next key date · one-line read. Prices are Friday 31 July cash closes unless flagged * (index-level, approximate or delayed). No charts.

US — the two that moved the index

Amazon (AMZN) \$271.58 ▲ +15.32% Cap \$2.92T Next: Reported 30 Jul AWS +37% to \$42.2bn, fastest in 15 quarters. Added ~\$388bn of value. Capex to ~\$220bn on memory costs.	Apple (AAPL) \$308.91 ▼ -7.35% Cap \$4.54T Next: Reported 30 Jul Services and China short; Sept quarter guided light on supply constraints. Cook's final earnings call.
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US — mega-caps

Alphabet (GOOGL)	Microsoft (MSFT)
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\$356.13 ▲ +6.73% Cap \$4.36T Next: Reported 22 Jul Google Cloud +82%. Bid on AI monetisation two days after being sold as a defensive.	\$464.72 ▲ +3.02% Cap \$3.45T Next: Reported 29 Jul Up >20% in July — best month since October 2007. Azure past \$100bn annual revenue.
Nvidia (NVDA) \$200.75 ▲ +2.93% Cap \$4.86T Next: Reports late Aug Back over \$200 and the largest company on earth. Participating, not leading, for a third session.	Meta (META) \$556.71 ▲ +3.28% Cap \$1.42T Next: Reported 29 Jul A bounce off a historic losing streak. Still ~30% below the 52-week high of \$796.25.
Tesla (TSLA) \$311.21 ▲ +0.76% Cap \$1.23T Next: Reported 22 Jul Held \$300 for a third session. The Mag7 laggard, with no catalyst of its own.	Broadcom (AVGO) \$389.28 ▲ +0.37% Cap \$1.85T Next: Reports early Sep Barely moved through the whole two-day round trip. Custom silicon sat this one out.

The memory complex — Friday’s reversal

Micron (MU) \$823.03 ▼ -5.90% Cap \$929.5B Next: Reports late Sep Traded \$930.88 to \$818.00. Gave back a third of Thursday’s +18.4% and then some. The tell.	AMD \$476.15 ▼ -1.90% Cap \$776.4B Next: Reports 5 Aug High \$515.62, close \$476.15. Reports Wednesday into a tape that has changed twice this week.
Intel (INTC) \$90.20 ▼ -1.02% Cap \$455.0B Next: Reported 24 Jul High \$97.90, close \$90.20. Most-active again. Six chipmakers were added to the US government portfolio.	Qualcomm (QCOM) \$147.61 ▼ -2.63% Cap \$155.0B Next: Reported 29 Jul Third down day since naming the memory crunch. The first company to flag it, and still paying for it.

Asia — the record, and the currency

Kospi (Korea) 6,595.45 ▲ +17.91% Cap — Next: Reopens Mon 3 Aug Best day in the index’s history. SK Hynix +25%, Samsung +20%, trading halted. Still ~29% off the high.	EWY (Korea ETF) \$157.10 ▼ -2.55% Cap — Next: Reopens Mon 3 Aug Traded \$166.04 and closed red. The US-listed mark on Korea’s record day — and Monday’s gap risk.
Nikkei 225 64,362.02 ▲ +4.03% Cap — Next: BoJ next: 18 Sep* Semis led. Now faces a 3.3% weekly yen appreciation and a US session that faded the whole move.	USD/JPY 157.40 ▼ -1.38% Cap — Next: BoJ held 31 Jul Second suspected intervention in 48 hours; -3.3% on the week, the most since July 2024. BoJ held 8–1.
Taiwan (TWII) 43,119.75 ▲ +7.98% Cap — Next: Reopens Mon 3 Aug Closed at the high of the day. Five sessions of damage reversed in one, on a foreign market’s cue.	Hang Seng 25,884.43 ▲ +0.10% Cap — Next: Reopens Mon 3 Aug Fourth green day and the calmest index in the region through the entire episode.

Energy, credit & the rest

Chevron (CVX) \$196.83 ▲ +2.35% Cap \$392.0B Next: Reported 31 Jul Net income \$12bn, ~+400% y/y; adj EPS \$6.06 vs \$5.56. Wirth: "firing on all cylinders."	Exxon (XOM) \$155.44 ▼ -0.97% Cap \$644.3B Next: Reported 31 Jul Beat on surging crude and still fell, down >2% intraday. The market is paying for refining, not integrated.
SpaceX (SPCX) \$108.37 ▼ -3.41% Cap \$1.43T Next: Reports 4 Aug Record low. -36% in a month, >\$1.2trn erased from the 16 June high. Short interest soaring into a share unlock.	Reddit (RDDT) \$140.67 ▼ -20.99% Cap \$27.1B Next: Reported 30 Jul Worst day on record. No new AI licensing deals and a US daily-user miss. The first crack in the data-asset trade.
Coinbase (COIN) \$146.26 ▼ -10.59% Cap \$38.5B Next: Reported 30 Jul Third consecutive quarterly loss, into a bitcoin below both TRADE and TREND.	Novo Nordisk (NVO) \$47.08 ▼ -8.78% Cap \$208.2B Next: Reported 31 Jul Ziltivekimab failed to reduce major adverse cardiovascular events. Healthcare was the worst sector.

Sources

Index closes, Mag7, sector performance, world indices, futures, commodities, Treasuries, FX and crypto: Yahoo Finance market data captured 06:50–07:30 GMT+8 Saturday 1 August via logged-in browser (US cash closes are official 16:00 EDT Friday prints; commodity and futures levels are 16:59 EDT electronic quotes). Monthly performance computed from Yahoo Finance monthly historical series (June closes: S&P 7,499.36; Nasdaq Composite 26,213.72; Dow 52,319.20). 2-year Treasury yield: CNBC US2Y quote page, 17:05 EDT. Session narrative, intraday detail, premarket moves, single-stock percentages and corporate news: CNBC "Stock market news for July 31, 2026" live blog (Liz Napolitano, Sarah Min, Ananya Chetia, Davis Giangliullo, Deena Zaidi, Tobias Burns, Spencer Kimball, Elsa Ohlen, Michelle Fox, Jeff Cox, Lee Ying Shan, Hugh Leask, Anniek Bao, Jenny Lee, Justina Lee, Sawdah Bhaimiya, Joseph Wilkins, Yun Li, Scott Schnipper) and Yahoo Finance "Stock market today" live blog (Grace O'Donnell and Ines Ferré, 31 Jul). Bank of Japan decision, vote split and Outlook Report: CNBC (Lim Hui Jie), Japan Times, Bloomberg, Reuters/Investing.com. Yen intervention: CNBC, UBS (Paul Donovan). Q2 employment cost index and final University of Michigan sentiment: US Bureau of Labor Statistics and University of Michigan via CNBC (Jeff Cox). China official manufacturing PMI: National Bureau of Statistics via CNBC. Warsh FOMC meeting-frequency proposal: New York Times via Bloomberg, US News and Investing.com. Geopolitics: CNBC "Iran targets U.S. assets in Kuwait, Bahrain after Egypt drone attack" (31 Jul, incl. Kevin Breuninger), Fars via CNBC, Verisk Maplecroft (Hamish Kinnear), Commonwealth Bank of Australia, Reuters/Rigzone on the monthly crude gain. Risk Ranges, TREND signals, Quads, portfolio actions, MOMO Tracker and Crypto Quant: Hedgeye Early Look "Crash, Bounce, Then?" (Keith McCullough, 31 Jul 07:38 EDT), Hedgeye "CHART OF THE DAY: The Bigger The Crash, The More Deceptive The Bounce" (31 Jul 07:36 EDT), Hedgeye Macro Show "Summary Notes & Replay I Friday, July 31st, 2026" (10:30 EDT) and "McCullough: Do What The Machine Is Doing" (18:03 EDT), Hedgeye "UPDATE: 2 New ETF Pro Changes" (10:35 EDT), Hedgeye MOMO Tracker (08:34 EDT) and Crypto Quant (07:06 EDT), Hedgeye Portfolio Solutions Daily ETF Re-Rank and Signal Strength Stocks — logged-in FULL edition. Week-ahead calendar: Yahoo Finance economic calendar and CNBC/IG week-ahead previews.

Data-confidence

CROSS-CHECKS PASSED: every Friday close in this brief reconciles arithmetically against the 31 July edition's Thursday closes. Indices: S&P 7,437.63 → 7,489.72 (+52.09, +0.70%), Dow 52,208.06 → 52,485.03 (+276.97, +0.53%), Nasdaq 25,122.18 → 25,373.85 (+251.68, +1.00%), Russell 2,946.10 → 2,931.34 (−14.76, −0.50%), VIX 17.09 → 15.99 (−1.10, −6.44%). Asia ties exactly: Nikkei 61,867.43 → 64,362.02 (+2,494.59), Kospi 5,593.56 → 6,595.45 (+1,001.89), Taiwan 39,933.30 → 43,119.75 (+3,186.45), Hang Seng 25,858.88 → 25,884.43, Shanghai 3,804.69 → 3,832.26, ASX 8,967.70 → 8,976.80, Straits 5,673.58 → 5,628.50, Sensex 77,928.15 → 78,094.64. Every single-name close reconciles to the tick: AAPL 333.43 → 308.91, MSFT 451.10 → 464.72, NVDA 195.04 → 200.75, GOOGL 333.66 → 356.13, AMZN 235.50 → 271.58, META 539.03 → 556.71, TSLA 308.85 → 311.21, AVGO 387.84 → 389.28, MU 874.66 → 823.03, AMD 485.39 → 476.15, INTC 91.13 → 90.20, QCOM 151.60 → 147.61, XOM 156.97 → 155.44, CVX 192.31 → 196.83, SPCX 112.20 → 108.37. Commodities also tie to the prior edition's derived settles: gold 4,160.60 → 4,098.60 (−62.00), silver 59.02 → 57.78 (−1.24), WTI 83.59 → 86.80 (+3.21), Brent 89.03 → 90.12 (+1.09), nat gas 2.758 → 2.792 (+0.034). Monthly figures computed independently from June closes and consistent with CNBC's "fourth straight winning month" for the Dow (Apr +7.14%, May +2.78%, Jun +2.52%, Jul +0.32%).

KNOWN CONFLICTS — READ THIS: (1) Yahoo Finance's live blog states the Dow "recorded a 0.7% gain for the month of July"; computed from Yahoo's own June close of 52,319.20 the figure is +0.32%. This brief uses +0.32%. The "fourth straight winning month" claim holds on either basis. (2) The 2-year yield: this brief uses CNBC's 4.262% at 17:05 EDT against a stated previous close of 4.229%, giving +3.3bp. The 31 July edition published a Thursday 2Y of 4.25%, so the change would be +1.2bp on that basis — the level is firm, the delta is not. The 10Y (4.745%), 30Y (5.28%), 5Y (4.46%) and 13-week (3.682%) are Yahoo CBOE 15:00 EDT prints; the 2Y is a different snapshot time and the five should not be treated as one consistent curve. (3) DXY: the close of 99.80 is firm, but Yahoo reports the change as −0.06%, implying a Thursday close of 99.86 against the 99.97 published yesterday. USD/JPY has the same issue — Yahoo's −1.38% implies a prior of 159.61 against the 159.70 published yesterday. Levels are firm; percentage changes are Yahoo's own basis. (4) Crude: CNBC quoted WTI at \$82.24 (−1.62%) in Asian hours, then "flat at \$83.61" pre-open, then \$84.04 (+0.5%) mid-morning; the \$86.80 close (+3.84%) is Yahoo's 16:59 EDT electronic quote. The intraday path is well-evidenced but the magnitude of the late move rests on a single snapshot. (5) Bitcoin's −2.77% is a rolling 24-hour change, not a session change; against the ~\$64,840 published yesterday the move is roughly −2.9%.

KNOWN GAPS: Sector percentages are Yahoo's own sector classification, not GICS S&P sector indices, and will not tie exactly to CNBC prints. Yahoo's sector board again did not display Real Estate or Basic Materials at capture time, so those two are absent from the leaders/laggards list. Commodity "settles" are derived (live electronic quote less the stated change), not exchange settlement prints — the method is unchanged from prior editions and reconciled cleanly this morning. Single-name Asian moves (SK Hynix +25%, Samsung +20%, Advantest +18%, Disco +13%, Lasertec +12%, Tokyo Electron +9%, Renesas +10%, SoftBank +9%, LG Innotek +11.2%, Seoul Semiconductor +7.8%) are press-reported intraday percentages from CNBC, not closes captured in the same consistent snapshot. The SK Hynix line quoted in the 31 July edition (\$148.93) and the SKHHY ADR quoted by Yahoo on Friday (\$15.33, −2.91%, 3,900 shares traded) are different instruments; neither is a reliable mark and no SK Hynix ADR figure is carried in this edition's tables. Hedgeye's Friday MOMO Tracker and Crypto Quant bodies are published as images and are quoted from their headlines only; the Macro Week Summary Notes require a separate portal and their full contents were not retrieved. Micron's intraday high is Yahoo's day-range top (\$930.88); the reported +18.4% Thursday move and Friday's reversal are consistent but the round-trip percentage is derived, not sourced. USD/KRW was not captured and is worth checking independently before Monday's Seoul open.

TIMING & UNVERIFIED: This is a WEEKEND edition. All cash and futures markets are closed; CME Globex reopens Sunday 18:00 EDT (06:00 GMT+8 Monday) and Asian cash markets on Monday 3 August. Every price in this brief is a Friday close and will be at least 48 hours stale by the time it can be acted on. The next Hedgeye Early Look and Risk Range set publishes Monday ~19:25 GMT+8, after which every range in section 4 is superseded. The BoJ's next scheduled meeting date (18 September) is the conventional calendar and was not confirmed against a primary BoJ release; Bloomberg's reporting that "September is live" is the sourced claim, the date is not. Hedgeye's "High Beta Momentum rebounded approximately 14%" and "roughly 60% below its peak" are quoted from the AI-generated Macro Show summary, which carries its own error disclaimer, and the 14% appears to span Thursday and Friday combined rather than one session. The Fars report that the IRGC stopped two tankers is IRGC-linked state media and CNBC explicitly could not verify it — yet it is the proximate cause given for a 5% intraday reversal in crude. The Kuwait and Bahrain strike claims are Iranian army statements via Iranian state media; no independent confirmation of damage was available at the time of writing. Warsh's meeting-frequency proposal is New York Times reporting citing officials familiar with the discussions, not an announced Fed decision. Week-ahead earnings dates (SpaceX 4 Aug, AMD 5 Aug) are carried from Yahoo and CNBC previews. Consensus for the 7 August unemployment rate (5.4%) is a single-source figure. Brief generated ~07:50 GMT+8 Saturday off a data snapshot taken 06:50–07:30. Verify live before acting. This is the FULL Hedgeye edition (logged-in browser reachable).